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1 In-Class Exercise: From Interest → Sprint 1 Proposal Skeleton

- **Purpose:** By the end of today's session, you will have a **clear starting point** for Sprint 1.
 - You will **not** build anything yet.
 - You will **not** finish your proposal.
 - Your goal is to design a **viable project direction** and make the structure explicit.
- Today's work is meant to **reduce ambiguity**, not to impress.
- **Time Available:** 45 minutes total (including short discussion and showcasing your artifacts at the end).

2 Step 1: SOURCES (10 min)

1. Choose a topic you are genuinely interested in. You may use a free topic from the shared project list in Canvas or propose your own.
2. Open notebooklm.google.com and start a **new notebook**.
3. in the **Sources** panel of the dashboard, click on + **Add sources**.
4. In the search field **Search the web for new sources** put your search prompt. For example, for my demo project, I used the prompt: "**An agent to help me learn ecclesiastical Latin**".
5. The AI will search for sources and likely find a bunch. Some will not be accessible (they appear in red and you should remove them). Others will be stupid and you can delete them. But you likely end up with a few relevant ones.
6. Once you're done adding external sources, add the sprint 1 review instructions: tinyurl.com/os-26-sprint-1-instructions

Purpose: You are putting **constraints** (Sprint rules) and **content** (your source) into the same reasoning space.

3 Step 2: CHAT (20 minutes)

Run the following prompts **exactly** (one at a time) **inside your NotebookLM**.

- Get them from here so that you don't have to type them in: tinyurl.com/sprint1-prompts
 - When you are satisfied with the answers, save them as **notes** in your notebook (**add note**).
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1. Prompt 1 - Customize response

For all answers in this session:

- Bullet points only.
- Max 5 bullets total.
- Each bullet 10 words.
- No prose, no paragraphs.
- No justification or elaboration.
- Focus on structure, not content.

2. Prompt 2 — Project Path

Based only on the uploaded source and the Sprint 1 instructions, what kind of project does this topic best support: a build-oriented single agent or a research deep dive? Briefly explain why.

3. Prompt 3 — Proposal Skeleton

Based on the Sprint 1 proposal structure (problem, reason, constraints, goals, metrics, references), do NOT write a proposal.

Instead:

- list what information would be required for each section
- state what can be inferred from the uploaded source
- state what would still require human decisions or clarification

Present the result as a checklist or table.

4. Prompt 4 — Next Actions

Do not assume this project is finalized.

Identify:

- the key decisions that must be made before a Sprint 1 proposal can be written
- the main risks related to scope, feasibility, or clarity
- what information or feedback would reduce each risk

Present the result as short bullet points. Do not suggest implementation steps or timelines.

Rules:

- Do not ask for “better ideas.”
- Do not ask for examples from other students.
- Treat gaps and uncertainty as **useful signals**.
- Point out to the bot when the format/content gets too dense for you to understand, and ask for a simpler/shorter version.

4 Step 3: STUDIO (10 minutes)

Ask NotebookLM to generate **one visual artifact**:

1. In the **Sources**, check all your sources so that they are included.
2. Open the **Infographic** menu in the **Studio** panel.
3. At the **Studio** prompt, enter the following text (copy it from tinyurl.com/sprint1-visual)

Create a one-page infographic that explains:

- the project goal
- the chosen project path (build or research)
- the workflow or reasoning flow (inputs → process → outputs)
- open questions, risks, or assumptions

This is for explaining the project in class, not for marketing.

If the result (which should take 5 min to be generated) is not to your liking, alter the prompt accordingly.

Optional (if time): Ask for a short slide deck (about 5 slides) explaining the same structure. Ask in "Chat" for a prompt for such a presentation.

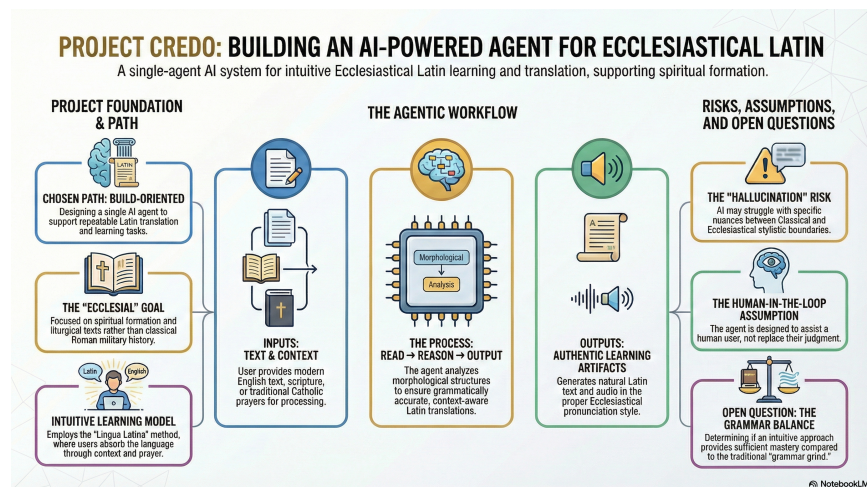
5 Step 4: Submit + Reflect (5 minutes)

1. Export the infographic as an image.
2. Upload it to Canvas for today's participation credit.
3. Keep your NotebookLM notebook — you will reuse it for Sprint 2.

Be ready to discuss:

- Where did the outline feel weak or unclear?
- What required **your** judgment rather than the AI's?
- Did this exercise change which project path you prefer?

6 My example: Project Credo



Sources prompt: "An agent to help me learn ecclesiastical Latin"
(Based on 9 sources and the prompt from the exercise.)

7 My prompt for the NotebookLM exercise

Okay, I want to design an exercise for the students for today. available time with discussion (15 min) at end: 45 minutes.

Students need to pick one of two project paths:

- building something
- doing some research

In the first sprint they shall only design a proposal.

I need an idea for an exercise today that enables them to complete the attached instruction set.

What I had in mind:

- ask them to superficially research ("grab") at least one source related to a topic on or off the list that they are interested in.
- create a new notebook & upload the source to NotebookLM, as well as any relevant course material (e.g. the sprint 1 instructions)
- query NotebookLM on best next steps for this project.
- ask for a summary in the form of an infographic (to be shown in class)
- ask for a short slide deck explaining the steps
- upload the infographic for points at the end of class.